



STATUS REPORT

# South Sudan: status report

Edition of 2026-08-11 · 63 systems and instruments tracked, 12 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-11 from the Data Landscapers source base, from `outputs/reports/SSD/ledger.csv` (63 systems and instruments, 12 of them Not held). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

## Summary of position

South Sudan is placed 192nd of 193 on the UN E-Government Development Index for 2024, and what it has built since collects revenue rather than delivers services. Interbank settlement went live in October 2025, and cash was removed as a channel for passport payments in January 2026 and tax at revenue offices in July 2026.

Identity is the structural gap: the World Bank's ID4D diagnostic puts close to 90% of the population without any government-recognised identification and about 90% of births unrecorded. A digital national identity card and a centralised civil register were announced on 28 July 2026 with no law, budget, timetable, vendor or platform named.

Governance follows the systems. A cybercrime statute is in force from February 2026 while no data-protection statute exists, and the e-Government platform most of this revenue flows through has run since 2019 under a single-sourced concession a UN commission has examined at length.

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small>  | AS AT                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bayobab national and cross-border fibre network        | IN DEVELOPMENT <small>↗</small> | Project moved to execution with NCT South Sudan, early 2026             |
| Mobile coverage extension in Kauto Administrative Area | PLANNED <small>↗</small>        | A coverage extension expected from February 2026 has not been delivered |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small>  | AS AT                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MTN South Sudan mobile operator licence                | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>    | 15-year operator licence awarded, April 2025                                                              |
| National fibre backbone programme (2,400 km via Kenya) | IN DEVELOPMENT <small>↗</small> | Fibre tendering stated to start in the second half of 2026 in the project's seventh implementation report |
| National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy           | IN DEVELOPMENT <small>↗</small> | Inception workshop closed; methodology, work plan and governance structures agreed                        |
| Regulator's power to order platform blocking           | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>    | The NCA ordered internet service providers to block social media for 30 to 90 days                        |
| South Sudan International Gateway (SSIGW)              | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>    | Operated by MGI Communications, a Swiss company, under a new oversight committee                          |
| Telecommunications tariff exchange-rate adjustment     | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>    | Phase two effective midnight on 26 July 2026, after phase one on 26 June                                  |
| Satellite broadband licensing and market access        | NOT HELD                        | One account names a rural Starlink partnership; no licence, authorisation or access terms are held        |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | STATUS <small>↗ source</small>  | AS AT                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gateway Services and Data Centre Oversight Committee | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>    | Constituted by the NCA with MGI Communications, 17 January 2026                  |
| Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines         | PLANNED <small>↗</small>        | Recorded as unpublished in the regional project's seventh implementation report  |
| National data centre, Juba                           | IN DEVELOPMENT <small>↗</small> | Described as halfway complete by the ICT minister at the Connected Africa Summit |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CREI solar-hybrid telecom energy programme | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Finnfund follow-on of US\$5m, bringing its total investment to US\$10m |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Financial Services Security Lab           | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Stood up by the NCA and the Bank of South Sudan with the ITU                        |
| National computer security incident response team | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Recorded as not established in the regional project's seventh implementation report |

Two backbone programmes are under construction, neither with a completion date: a state one that moved from a US\$9m design budget in June 2025 to a 2,400 km route through Kenya announced in October 2025, and a private one under Bayobab's 15-year licence, effective 16 October 2025, in execution with NCT South Sudan from early 2026. Fibre tendering for the state programme is stated to start in the second half of 2026.

The cost of connection has risen twice and the new prices are unpublished. The regulator approved a phased tariff exchange-rate adjustment to avert what it called network collapse in June 2026, and phase two took effect at midnight on 26 July 2026. Neither the regulator nor the operators have published the revised rates or said how many further phases are planned.

Rural coverage is where the gap is concrete: in Kauto Administrative Area, [one site at Kuron carries the only signal](#), [four more have been requested for years](#), and an extension expected from February 2026 has not been delivered.

The power behind it is private: Finnfund has put [US\\$10m into CREI for solar-hybrid energy at MTN's telecom sites](#), 490 of 499 renovated, with coverage reported up from 69% to 80% over three years.

[MGI Communications, a Swiss operator, holds both the international gateway and the national data centre](#), under an oversight committee the regulator constituted in January 2026. The data centre was [described as halfway complete in April 2026](#) having been [reported as nearing completion in September 2025](#); the two have not been reconciled.

No construction record for the facility is published anywhere the wiki can reach, as at 9 August 2026. Searched that day: the regulator's own publications page carries five documents, none of them about the data centre and none later than a 2022 conference report; the regulator's news feed mentions neither the facility's progress nor the oversight committee's output; the ICT ministry's website publishes nothing after 18 December 2025; and MGI Communications has issued no statement on the build. The absence is the finding — a facility the state calls a strategic national asset, contracted to a foreign operator and placed under a dedicated oversight committee, has no published procurement record, contract, commissioning schedule or progress report. Both dated accounts are summit remarks, and neither is a construction report.

The donor and corporate routes are now closed too, as at 10 August 2026, and their closure is itself informative. The [Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project \(P176181\)](#) is the only World Bank digital operation covering South Sudan, and its Implementation Status and Results Report of 30 June 2026 carries no data-centre workstream at all — the South Sudan component is fibre backbone, a national CSIRT and a research network, and the CSIRT is recorded as not established, unchanged from its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target — while a full-text search of the Bank's document archive returns nothing on a South Sudan national data centre. The facility is not donor-financed, which is why the archive that reliably publishes procurement records holds none for it. MGI Communications is a privately held Swiss company of about nine people in Zug that files no public accounts, and its own site carries no statement on the facility.

The same report does establish one thing dated: the project's results framework records "guidelines on government data hosting, including adoption of cloud computing" for South Sudan as *not published*, measured 16 June 2026 — unchanged from its November 2022 baseline, against a target of April 2028. So the state is building a national data centre with no published policy governing what may be hosted in it.

It is not established that there is only one facility. The regulator's January 2026 statement describes MGI in the present tense as managing "critical data centre infrastructure" alongside the gateway; the minister in April 2026 describes a national data centre being built and halfway complete; the September 2025 account describes a Juba data hub nearing completion. Whether these are one facility reported inconsistently or two cannot be chosen on anything the wiki holds, and no source distinguishes them.

Spectrum governance is at inception: the [5G and spectrum strategy has a work plan and no band plan](#). The regulator has meanwhile exercised a power for which no instrument is published, [blocking social media for 30 to 90 days in January 2025](#).

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Real-time gross settlement component | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Exceptional uptake reported by the central bank and the Finance Ministry |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity and passport production machines | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Five machine systems delivered — two for passports, three for identity and nationality documents                                                  |
| National Identity Card issuance           | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | School-based registration launched for examination candidates at Juba Day Secondary School, 4 August 2026, with expansion to more schools planned |
| Nationality Certificate (Jinsia)          | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | About 10% of the population holds one                                                                                                             |
| New-generation passport and EAC passport  | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Announced for August 2027; ten-year validity would require amending the passport act                                                              |
| Passport issuance                         | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | 37,500 further booklets received; stock stated as sufficient to December 2026                                                                     |
| Personal identity card (Butaka Shakhisia) | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Required for banking, land transactions and court processes; 380,000 held by the directorate                                                      |
| Unified national digital identity system  | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Announced: a digital national identity card for every citizen aged 18 and over                                                                    |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cash payment of tax at revenue offices                      | DISCONTINUED <small>↗</small>  | Barred by resolution of the Ministerial High-Level Committee on Economic Reform, effective immediately |
| Cashless payment for passports and identity documents       | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Cash abolished for passport and identity payments after a supply crisis                                |
| Mobile money as legal tender                                | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Affirmed by the Bank of South Sudan under the 2017 Electronic Money Regulation                         |
| Mobile money services (MTN MoMo, Digitel)                   | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Operators pledged nationwide agent expansion with the central bank                                     |
| National Instant Payment System (NIPS)                      | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Roadmap development announced with AfricaNenda after a 2023 proof of concept                           |
| South Sudan Interbank Payment and Settlement System (SSIPS) | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Launched with 13 banks; all licensed banks mandated by 31 January 2026                                 |

### Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                       | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Centralised civil registration and vital statistics system | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Announced: health facilities to notify births, the directorate to be sole issuing authority, death registration compulsory |
| Digital land register                                      | NOT HELD                       | One expert's advocacy for a central digital land database; no programme, instrument or system is held                      |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Biometric registration of public servants              | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Third phase launched for the organised forces, June 2026                                          |
| Education in Emergencies Management Information System | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Launched on the DHIS2 platform with UNESCO and the HISP Centre, after training 35 master trainers |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Crawford Capital e-Government concession                | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Exclusive e-Government services contract signed 16 November 2019 without competitive tender          |
| Electronic cargo tracking                               | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Introduced by the revenue authority for inbound goods                                                |
| Electronic visa portal                                  | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Revised fees published on the portal, applications online only with a stated 72-hour processing time |
| Ensoft telecom revenue-assurance build-operate-transfer | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Six-year agreement signed by the revenue authority and the NCA; the vendor takes 3.56%               |
| NCA e-Services Platform                                 | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Launched, digitising licensing, payments and regulatory workflows                                    |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| State or county digital service delivery | NOT HELD                       | One state-level skills programme is held and no local digital-service system, platform or mandate is |

## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Earth-observation or geospatial data programme | NOT HELD                       | No programme document, agency mandate or published output is held |

Identity is the defining gap and every credential is scarce. About [10% of the population holds a Nationality Certificate](#), the prerequisite for the National Identity Card, and the directorate [held 380,000 personal identity cards in January 2026](#), required for banking, land and court. Stock held and cards issued are reported on different bases and no reconciled coverage figure exists. National Identity Card distribution, running in Greater Yei since July 2026, [extended to a school-based registration campaign for examination candidates at Juba Day Secondary School on 4 August 2026](#), with the directorate stating plans to reach more schools; no national coverage figure is published.

What recovered in 2026 was supply, not systems: [five production machines in May 2026](#) and [37,500 passport booklets in July, with stock stated to December 2026](#) and processing at about three days.

Everything above it is announced rather than built: a [digital national identity card for every adult and a centralised register of births, deaths, marriages and divorces](#) were set out on 28 July 2026 as intent only. The one biometric register that exists is a payroll: a [US\\$15m World Bank-backed registration of public servants](#), extended to the [organised forces in June 2026](#), with data on a Ministry of Finance server and no data-protection authority.

Payments have wholesale plumbing and no retail rail. SSIPS went live on 10 October 2025 with 13 banks, combining real-time gross settlement and automated clearing on ISO 20022; the retail instant system announced with AfricaNenda in February 2025 has no documented go-live and its December 2025 target passed. Retail payments run on telecom mobile money, legal tender since July 2025 with no conduct supervision on record.

Service delivery is revenue-first: the regulator's e-Services Platform, an e-visa portal charging US\$50 for citizens of Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda and DR Congo, and electronic cargo tracking, all from 2026. Beyond revenue, the one operating information system of scale is the education ministry's, launched on 5 August 2026 on the DHIS2 platform the health ministry has run since 2018.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | STATUS <small>↗ source</small>                                | AS AT                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act 2026 | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>                                  | Signed by the President on 18 February 2026                                                           |
| ICT Authority                            | IN DEVELOPMENT, STATUTORY BASIS UNRECONCILED <small>↗</small> | The ministry briefed the President on establishing the body while awaiting the passage of legislation |
| South Sudan Official Gazette             | IN DEVELOPMENT <small>↗</small>                               | Technical committee formed by the President and given 14 days to report, 12 January 2026              |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full-digitisation decree (Electronic Services Council) | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Presidential decree granting the Electronic Services Council full authority, with a January 2026 adoption deadline |
| National e-commerce strategy                           | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Recorded as non-existent in the regional project's seventh implementation report                                   |

### Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kenya-South Sudan cross-border digital connectivity memorandum | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Recorded as delivered in the regional project's seventh implementation report |

### Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Data Protection Bill                  | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | The ICT minister states a bill will come in 2026; a policy bill was drafted in October 2025               |
| Comprehensive data-protection statute | NOT HELD                       | Only the Transitional Constitution's article 22 privacy right; no statute and no commission as at 2026-08 |

## EU activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| European Union digital cooperation instrument | NOT HELD                       | EU funds appear only through the European Fund for Sustainable Development Plus backing a Finnish investor's telecom-energy stake; no bilateral instrument is held |

## Open data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Open government data portal or policy | NOT HELD                       | No portal, open-data policy or public-sector information instrument is held |

The state acquired enforcement powers before rights. The [Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act was signed on 18 February 2026](#), criminalising hacking and cyberterrorism alongside false information, online impersonation and hate speech, and its [full text was withheld from journalists at signing](#). There is no data-protection statute, only the Transitional Constitution's article 22 privacy right: a [policy bill was drafted in October 2025](#) and the ICT minister [said a bill would come in 2026](#), but none is before the Assembly.

The institution meant to regulate the sector has an unsettled legal basis, and the two accounts of it come from the same man. On 21 May 2026 the ICT minister Ateny Wek Ateny said in terms that the statute existed — "[the law is now out already and it has been signed by the president](#)", the remark [reported the same day as a signed legal framework](#); on 5 August 2026 the same minister's briefing to the President was reported as putting a regulator in place [while the government awaits the passage of legislation](#). This is one minister's account changing over eleven weeks, not two outlets disagreeing. Neither states how the Authority's competence divides from the existing regulator's.

No instrument creating the Authority can be found in any published register, as at 9 August 2026. The Ministry of Justice's national law collection lists 77 Acts, the most recent the Labour Act 2017, and does not carry the Cybercrime and Computer Misuse Act 2026 either, so an absence there is no evidence of non-existence. The Office of the President's *Decrees and Orders* page publishes no documents. The Assembly's bills register stops in August 2023 and names no ICT Authority Bill, and the ICT ministry's news feed ends on 18 December 2025. The statutory basis of a regulator can be asserted on a podium and neither confirmed nor refuted from any published source.

The reason no instrument can be produced is that South Sudan has no gazette to produce it from, as at 10 August 2026. On 12 January 2026 the President ordered an eight-member committee to [operationalise the South Sudan Official Gazette within fourteen days](#) and to clear a publication backlog covering every critical law, republican decree, order and resolution enacted since 2011 — an official admission that the state has published no authoritative record of its own legislation in the fourteen years since independence. The committee was to submit Volume One for the President to launch; no maiden edition, physical or electronic, is on file seven months later. The same week the Office of the President classified all documents bearing the President's signature as "privileged executive communication" that [cannot be photographed, scanned or shared online](#), with decrees delivered confidentially to the officeholder concerned — so the one class of document that would settle the Authority's status is under an explicit bar on circulation. The Assembly offers no second route: its Hansard and document pages return

404 and its bills page is a procedural explainer rather than a register. Whether the ICT Authority has a statute is therefore unknowable from any public record South Sudan currently maintains, and will stay so until the gazette runs.

The World Bank's [seventh implementation report on the Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project](#) records the first cross-border digital connectivity memorandum between Kenya and South Sudan as delivered, offered as [the template for the remaining bilaterals](#); no text, capacity or tariff terms are published, and the same report records that no national e-commerce strategy exists, unchanged from its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target.

The largest governance question concerns a contract, not a statute. Under a [single-sourced contract of 16 November 2019](#), Crawford Capital is the exclusive provider of e-Government services covering trade permits, visas, tax, customs and work permits. The UN Commission on Human Rights in South Sudan records that the Ministry of Finance approved single-sourcing noting a national security concern, following written advice from the then head of the Internal Security Bureau that the company should work with its ICT department; it concludes that the services are likely to be used without regard for data protection to facilitate unlawful state surveillance. That conclusion is the Commission's. The Commission puts the eServices profit share at 75% to the contractor; the company [says it takes a 2% platform service fee](#), describing a separate tax contract, and the [government calls the engagement lawful and cabinet-endorsed](#). The accounts are unreconciled.

The digitisation mandate itself is a decree: in December 2025 the President [granted the Electronic Services Council full authority to digitise all government institutions, with a January 2026 deadline](#), and no compliance report has been published since.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National artificial-intelligence strategy or programme | NOT HELD                       | The ICT undersecretary named infrastructure, a data centre and skills as prerequisites in April 2025; no strategy, policy or programme is held |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                       |
|----------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| eSIM service         | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Launched by MTN South Sudan |

### US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| United States sanctions on the e-Government contractor | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Crawford Capital sanctioned by the US State Department, May 2026 |



## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                           |
|----------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Huawei re-engagement | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Re-engagement reported after the post-2014 rift |

## India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Indian digital cooperation with South Sudan | NOT HELD                       | No India-South Sudan digital agreement, line of credit or programme document is held |

## Gulf/UAE activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gulf-state digital investment in South Sudan | NOT HELD                       | No Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering digital infrastructure is held |

There is no national artificial-intelligence strategy, policy or programme on file. What is held is a statement of prerequisites: at the Kigali summit in April 2025 the ICT undersecretary [named robust infrastructure, a quality data centre and skilled people as the conditions](#), without which the country would hardly benefit.

External engagement is limited. [Huawei re-engaged in 2026 after the post-2014 rift](#), expressing interest in the national data hub with no agreement, contract or figure attached, and [named electricity as the major impediment](#). The [United States sanctioned the e-Government contractor in May 2026](#) – secondary-sourced, no designation notice held – and the concession continues to operate.

No India-South Sudan digital agreement and no Gulf-state investment in digital infrastructure is held.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                           |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Operator tariff reduction | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | MTN cut tariffs by 25%, with the ICT ministry pressing for more |

### Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                      | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Innovation for Skills and Knowledge programme (Central Equatoria) | PLANNED <small>↗</small>       | Costed at US\$2,806,100 for three centres training more than 8,000 people |
| Educational Technical Cooperation Project (China)                         | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | US\$22,336,740 committed for the second phase                             |

## Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Public research programme in digital or data science | NOT HELD                       | No research programme document, university centre mandate or published research output is held |

Access is low and improving slowly: the regulator reported internet users rising from [1.3 million to 1.9 million and penetration from 12% to 15.7% between 2024 and 2025](#). No later measurement is held, so the effect of the past year's tariff changes cannot be stated.

Affordability moved backwards. Mobile data was [about US\\$23.70 per gigabyte in November 2025](#); MTN cut tariffs [by 25% the following month](#), and two exchange-rate adjustments then [raised charges again with no revised rate published](#).

Skills provision is a costed plan: three centres in Central Equatoria for over 8,000 people at a [stated US\\$2,806,100, with no financier or start date](#). The older commitments are Chinese – [US\\$22,336,740 for the Educational Technical Cooperation Project in 2020](#) – and the largest is not a digital-services project at all: [US\\$271,154,617 from China Eximbank for an air traffic management system in 2018](#). No national budget, annex or appropriation line for the ICT ministry, the National Communication Authority or the Electronic Services Council is held, so what the state itself spends on any of these systems cannot be stated.

The largest external programme is the World Bank's [Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project, at US\\$162m of IDA after a US\\$10m partial cancellation in Somalia in April 2026](#); its mid-term review raised the development-objective rating to Moderately Satisfactory while fiduciary and environmental and social risk stayed High. Private-sector investment mobilised in South Sudan is US\$0 against a US\$20m target.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | Seventh implementation report issued after the mid-term review of January to April 2026 |

### MoUs and other agreements

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Air Traffic Management System loan (China Eximbank) | IMPLEMENTED <small>↗</small>   | US\$271,154,617 committed |

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | STATUS <small>↗ source</small> | AS AT                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation | NOT HELD                       | No budget, annex or appropriation line for the ICT ministry, the NCA or the Electronic Services Council is held |

*(narrative not yet written)*

## Gaps to fill

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                             | LAST PROBED    |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Satellite broadband licensing and market access          | A satellite-broadband licence, authorisation register or NCA decision on market access.                                          | not yet probed |
| Digital land register                                    | A land-registry digitisation programme document, procurement or ministerial decision.                                            | not yet probed |
| Earth-observation or geospatial data programme           | A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate.                                        | not yet probed |
| State or county digital service delivery                 | A state or county digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.                                        | not yet probed |
| Comprehensive data-protection statute                    | The Data Protection Bill as introduced, or an enacted data-protection statute and the instrument constituting its commission.    | 2026-08-09     |
| Open government data portal or policy                    | A national open-data portal, an open-data policy, or a public-sector information reuse instrument.                               | not yet probed |
| European Union digital cooperation instrument            | An EU-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, Global Gateway commitment or delegation programme document.                     | not yet probed |
| National artificial-intelligence strategy or programme   | A national AI strategy, policy or programme document, or a ministerial decision establishing one.                                | not yet probed |
| Indian digital cooperation with South Sudan              | Any India-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document.                                       | not yet probed |
| Gulf-state digital investment in South Sudan             | A Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering South Sudanese digital infrastructure.                                 | not yet probed |
| Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation | The national budget or its annexes showing appropriation lines for the ICT ministry, the NCA or the Electronic Services Council. | 2026-08-09     |
| Public research programme in digital or data science     | A public research programme, university research-centre mandate or published research output in digital or data science.         | not yet probed |

Twelve rows are unheld. Half are instruments the state has said it intends — a data-protection statute, an open-data policy, an AI strategy, a land registry — where the intention is on record and the instrument is not. The rest are absences of a different sort: no domestic budget line, no public research programme, and no bilateral instrument with the EU, India or the Gulf. Two were probed on 9 August 2026 and both returned documents the wiki does not hold rather than an absence — a Data Protection Bill 2025 and the FY 2025/26 Appropriation Bill — now on the acquisition list. The other ten were not probed.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                   |
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| EDITION         | 2026-08-11                                                                                                                                                        |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.